

Business

1. Starbucks has been fighting to win back customers after a rough few years. The chain recently posted its fourth straight quarter of same-store sales growth under CEO Brian Niccol. What did Starbucks do with its full-year outlook as a result?
 - a. Raised it, signalling confidence the turnaround is holding
 - b. Left it unchanged, warning that tariffs could dent coffee prices
 - c. Cut it, blaming a slowdown in afternoon drink orders
2. Germany's car industry is having a rough time. BMW has recently joined Volkswagen, Porsche and Mercedes-Benz in announcing major job cuts. What is the main force driving this wave of layoffs across German automakers?
 - a. Rising steel costs caused by EU import tariffs on raw materials
 - b. Chinese electric vehicle rivals eating into their market share
 - c. A Europe-wide ban on diesel engines taking effect ahead of schedule
3. Oprah Winfrey founded a prestigious girls' school in South Africa nearly two decades ago. She has just announced a major change of direction — closing the campus after the 2027 academic year. What will she do instead of running a physical school?
 - a. Donate the campus buildings to the South African government to run
 - b. Expand her scholarship programme to support more students at existing schools
 - c. Convert the site into a leadership retreat centre for African women executives
4. McDonald's Korea recently launched a burger featuring locally grown Chungju corn. Sales were halted nationwide almost immediately. Why?
 - a. The burger was so popular it sold out in under 48 hours, crashing the supply chain
 - b. Multiple customers reported biting into small stones hidden in the corn filling
 - c. A rival fast-food chain filed a trademark claim over the word 'Chungju'

Economics

5. Eurozone inflation (the rate at which prices across the euro currency area are rising) recently hit 2.9% in July — above the European Central Bank's 2% target. Price pressures varied widely between member states. Which of the following best explains why inflation rates differ so much across countries sharing the same currency?
 - a. Countries with faster wage growth tend to see higher services inflation locally
 - b. Countries with smaller economies automatically import more inflation from abroad
 - c. Countries with newer euro membership are exempt from ECB interest rate decisions

6. The IMF (International Monetary Fund, the global lender of last resort) recently completed a review of Egypt's economy, unlocking \$1.8 billion in new funding. Egypt's prime minister called it a 'vote of confidence'. Which of these is NOT typically a condition the IMF attaches to this kind of support?
 - a. Reducing government budget deficits by cutting spending or raising taxes
 - b. Allowing the currency to weaken toward its market value rather than fixing it artificially
 - c. Requiring the recipient country to run a trade surplus within one calendar year
 7. Renewed attacks on shipping in the Gulf and the Red Sea have recently pushed the price of crude oil past \$100 a barrel. The Strait of Hormuz is one of the world's most critical chokepoints for oil. Roughly what share of global oil supply passes through it?
 - a. Around one fifth of the world's oil supply
 - b. Around one third of the world's oil supply
 - c. Around half of the world's oil supply
 8. A recent Euronews study compared how long workers in different European countries need to work to afford a scoop of ice cream. Greece came out worst. How much longer does a Greek worker have to work for one scoop compared to a German worker?
 - a. About 50% longer
 - b. About twice as long
 - c. Nearly three times as long
- ### General Knowledge
9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cut flowers, supplying the majority of blooms sold in Europe and a significant share of global exports?
 - a. The Netherlands
 - b. Kenya
 - c. Colombia
 10. Which Scottish economist, born in 1723, argued that the wealth of nations came not from gold and silver but from the productive labour of ordinary people — a radical idea at the time?
 - a. David Hume
 - b. Adam Smith
 - c. John Locke

Business

1. Starbucks has been fighting to win back customers after a rough few years. The chain recently posted its fourth straight quarter of same-store sales growth under CEO Brian Niccol. What did Starbucks do with its full-year outlook as a result?
 - a. *Starbucks raised its full-year outlook, a sign that its turnaround under Brian Niccol is gaining real traction. Four consecutive quarters of same-store sales growth (revenue from locations open at least a year, a key retail health check) is meaningful momentum. Niccol, who was poached from Chipotle in 2024, has focused on fixing mobile ordering queues and restoring the in-store experience.*
2. Germany's car industry is having a rough time. BMW has recently joined Volkswagen, Porsche and Mercedes-Benz in announcing major job cuts. What is the main force driving this wave of layoffs across German automakers?
 - b. *Chinese EV makers have aggressively undercut German brands on price, especially in the crucial Chinese domestic market where VW and BMW once dominated. German automakers are now cutting thousands of jobs and restructuring to survive. Germany's car industry employs around 800,000 people directly, so the ripple effects on the broader economy are significant.*
3. Oprah Winfrey founded a prestigious girls' school in South Africa nearly two decades ago. She has just announced a major change of direction — closing the campus after the 2027 academic year. What will she do instead of running a physical school?
 - b. *Oprah will close the Oprah Winfrey Leadership Academy for Girls after 2027 but expand her scholarship programme, shifting from bricks-and-mortar to funding students at other institutions. The school opened in 2007 and Oprah invested heavily in it personally. The move reflects a broader debate about whether endowed schools or scalable scholarships deliver better long-term impact in education philanthropy.*
4. McDonald's Korea recently launched a burger featuring locally grown Chungju corn. Sales were halted nationwide almost immediately. Why?
 - b. *The Chungju corn cheese croquette burger was pulled after customers reported finding small stones in the filling — not the kind of crunch you want. McDonald's Korea pulled it nationwide almost immediately. The incident is a reminder that locally sourced ingredients, while great for marketing, can introduce supply chain quality risks that global sourcing networks are specifically designed to avoid.*

Economics

5. Eurozone inflation (the rate at which prices across the euro currency area are rising) recently hit 2.9% in July — above the European Central Bank's 2% target. Price pressures varied widely between member states. Which of the following best explains why inflation rates differ so much across countries sharing the same currency?
 - a. *Within a currency union, countries cannot adjust exchange rates or set their own interest rates, so local wage growth becomes a key driver of differing inflation rates — especially in services like restaurants and hairdressers, where labour costs dominate. Countries with tight labour markets and strong pay deals tend to run hotter than the eurozone average. This is a structural tension the ECB has to manage with a single interest rate for 20 very different economies.*

6. The IMF (International Monetary Fund, the global lender of last resort) recently completed a review of Egypt's economy, unlocking \$1.8 billion in new funding. Egypt's prime minister called it a 'vote of confidence'. Which of these is NOT typically a condition the IMF attaches to this kind of support?
 - c. *The IMF does not typically demand a trade surplus on a fixed timeline — that would be unrealistic and counterproductive. Standard IMF conditions focus on fiscal discipline (cutting deficits), currency reform (moving toward market exchange rates), and structural reforms like reducing energy subsidies. Egypt has been through a painful adjustment including a sharp devaluation of the Egyptian pound, which has hit ordinary households hard.*
 7. Renewed attacks on shipping in the Gulf and the Red Sea have recently pushed the price of crude oil past \$100 a barrel. The Strait of Hormuz is one of the world's most critical chokepoints for oil. Roughly what share of global oil supply passes through it?
 - a. *Roughly 20% of global oil supply — about one barrel in five — passes through the Strait of Hormuz, making it the single most important oil chokepoint on earth. The strait is only 33 kilometres wide at its narrowest. Combined with disruptions in the Red Sea, where Houthi attacks have rerouted dozens of tankers around Africa, the double pressure has been enough to push crude through the \$100 barrier.*
 8. A recent Euronews study compared how long workers in different European countries need to work to afford a scoop of ice cream. Greece came out worst. How much longer does a Greek worker have to work for one scoop compared to a German worker?
 - c. *A Greek worker needs nearly three times as much working time to afford a single scoop of ice cream as a German worker — a striking illustration of the gap between wages and prices across Europe. Greece has one of the EU's lower minimum wages, while ice cream is priced for tourists in many popular spots. It is a neat reminder that the 'cost of living' debate is really about two moving parts: prices AND wages.*
- ### General Knowledge
9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cut flowers, supplying the majority of blooms sold in Europe and a significant share of global exports?
 - b. *Kenya is the world's largest exporter of cut flowers by volume, supplying around 35–40% of all flowers sold in the EU. The Rift Valley's altitude, consistent sunlight, and cheap labour make it ideal for growing roses year-round. The Netherlands is the world's largest trading and auction hub for flowers — nearly half of Kenya's exports fly through Schiphol — but Kenya does the growing.*
 10. Which Scottish economist, born in 1723, argued that the wealth of nations came not from gold and silver but from the productive labour of ordinary people — a radical idea at the time?
 - b. *Adam Smith, born in Kirkcaldy in 1723, published The Wealth of Nations in 1776 — the same year as American independence. His argument that free markets and the division of labour, not hoarded precious metals, created prosperity was genuinely revolutionary. He also gave us the concept of the 'invisible hand' — the idea that individuals pursuing self-interest can inadvertently benefit society as a whole.*